

Mediating a Workplace Disagreement

Scenario: Two colleagues disagree over how to divide credit on a shared project, and a manager must mediate.

		
COLLEAGUE A Feels their contribution was overlooked.	COLLEAGUE B Feels they did the harder work.	MANAGER Must listen to both sides and propose a fair resolution.

TASK STEPS	USEFUL PHRASES
1. Listen to both sides	● I understand where you're coming from, but...
2. Acknowledge feelings	● Let's find a solution that works for both of you.
3. Propose a compromise	● What would you consider fair?
4. Agree on next steps	● Can we agree on how to share the credit? ● Let's clarify the next steps together.